

company, before retiring, and managed the careers of many others in the process. One of his key principles for those looking to earn more money is to “continue learning and developing your skills.”

ESI practices what he preaches. He achieved FI by saving a high percentage of his salary and investing in passive index funds. He then became a real estate investor. He retired at age fifty-two. In “retirement,” he’s developed his blog into a viable business and purchased another successful website, *Rockstar Finance*. He essentially achieved FI three different ways, using all three investment paths—index funds, personal business, and real estate—discussed later in the book.

ESI emphasized that learning can range from furthering formal education to something as simple as utilizing time wisely when doing menial tasks, such as listening to audiobooks or podcasts. He emphasized the need to develop skills that have a financial payoff. He highlighted communication, sales, and negotiating as particularly valuable skills. Focusing on learning, growth, and development is a way of being proactive, even if you don’t have a clear endgame in sight.

Aggregating Marginal Gains